

AI Use Roadmap

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A practical learning path for using AI/LLMs in everyday work — no coding required

This roadmap is for people who want to use tools like Claude and ChatGPT to work faster and better day to day — writing, research, planning, data cleanup, meeting follow-ups — not for people learning to build or code AI systems. It draws on **Claude Academy**, **OpenAI Academy**, and well-regarded non-technical courses, newsletters, and podcasts.

Sources accessed September 2026.

Phase 1 — Foundations (Week 1)

Goal: understand what these tools actually are, and build the judgment to know when to trust their output.

Resource	Platform	Length	Why it's first
Claude 101	Claude Academy	2.5 hr	Core chat interface, prompting basics
Claude Platform 101	Claude Academy	1.5 hr	Where everything lives (web, desktop, mobile)
AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations	Claude Academy	4 hr	Mental model for what AI is good/bad at
AI Capabilities and Limitations	Claude Academy	3.5 hr	Calibrates trust — where to double-check output
Google AI Essentials	Google (Coursera)	~10 hr	Widely used, beginner-friendly intro to using AI at work, includes a certificate

Milestone: comfortable having a working conversation with an AI assistant and knowing when to double-check its answers.

Phase 2 — Prompting Well (Week 2)

Goal: get noticeably better results by asking better questions — the single highest-leverage everyday skill.

Resource	Platform	Length	Why it's next
Google Prompting Essentials	Google (Coursera)	~1 week, self-paced	Focused, practical course on writing effective prompts
Apply AI at Work	OpenAI Academy	—	AI basics through the lens of real workplace tasks

Milestone: able to write a prompt that gives a useful first draft instead of a generic one, and knows how to iterate on it.

Phase 3 — Everyday Productivity with Agents (Weeks 3-4)

Goal: move from a back-and-forth chat to handing off real multi-step tasks — the biggest jump in day-to-day usefulness.

Resource	Platform	Length	Why it matters
Introduction to Claude Cowork	Claude Academy	2.5 hr	Agentic workflows — describe a goal, get a finished file back (docs, spreadsheets, research)
Building Effective Human-Agent Teams	Claude Academy	45 min	How to delegate well and review an agent's work critically

Milestone: comfortable handing off a real task (a report draft, a data cleanup, organizing files, a research summary) to an AI agent and reviewing the result rather than doing it by hand.

Phase 4 — Applying It to Your Own Role (Ongoing)

Goal: build a personal library of tasks AI reliably helps with in your specific job.

Resource	Platform	Why it's useful
Generative AI for Everyone (Andrew Ng, DeepLearning.AI)	Coursera	Non-technical but goes deeper on business use cases, limitations, and how to spot good AI use cases in your own work
AI For Everyone		The original “how to think about AI at

(Andrew Ng, DeepLearning.AI)	Coursera	work” course — strategy-level, still non-technical
Specialized Claude Academy tracks (builders, educators, small business, students)	Claude Academy	Role-specific variants of the AI Fluency track

Milestone: a running list of 3–5 recurring tasks in your own role where AI reliably saves time, plus a clear sense of the tasks where it doesn’t.

Phase 5 — Staying Current (Ongoing, ~15-30 min/week)

AI tools change monthly. A short standing habit keeps you current without another course.

Resource	Format	Why it’s useful
TLDR AI	Daily email newsletter	Quick, skimmable daily digest of AI news and new tools
The Neuron	Daily email newsletter	Plain-English AI news aimed at a general professional audience
Superhuman AI	Daily email newsletter	Similar format, strong focus on practical tools you can use immediately
Lex Fridman Podcast	Podcast	Longer-form conversations with AI researchers and builders, for context beyond the news cycle

Additional Resources

Resource	Why it’s useful
Claude Academy	Full course catalog referenced throughout this roadmap — browse for new and updated courses
OpenAI Academy	Full course catalog referenced throughout this roadmap — browse for new and updated courses
@DeRonin_ roadmap	Note: this is a roadmap for becoming an <i>AI engineer</i> (building/coding AI systems), not for everyday AI use — a different track from the rest of this document
Building with the Claude API	Note: AI engineer track — building applications on top of

(Claude Academy)	Claude, not training models
<u>Build with AI</u> (OpenAI Academy)	Note: AI engineer track — designing, building, evaluating AI solutions with Codex and the OpenAI API
<u>LangChain for LLM Application Development</u> (DeepLearning.AI)	Note: AI engineer track — building LLM-powered applications with a popular framework
<u>AI Agents in LangGraph</u> (DeepLearning.AI)	Note: AI engineer track — building multi-step agent workflows
<u>Hugging Face Agents Course</u>	Note: AI engineer track — free, hands-on course on building AI agents
